

Narrative Package V3 — Fracture Compact

Package identity: V3 Fracture Compact

Game: Dark Matter: Genesis

Player: Kade

Setting: Io, 2160

Design mode: Politics / faction intrigue / territory fantasy

Kairos truth: Corporate black-box sync weapon archive

Memory Cores: Sync weapon cores, political leverage, repair keys

Ending triad: Expose / Weaponize / Broker

Designed hour target: 174 hours, exploration excluded

1. Premise, Tone, And Corporate Truth

Io is not an empty moon. It is a table where everyone arrived with a knife, a contract, or a dying friend.

Kade begins with **5000 Aether Credits (AC)** and one starter Skilled Companion, then grows a base camp of **22 companions** plus a switchable **expedition trio of 3** while the factions around them learn that survival is only the first negotiation.

The political fantasy is direct: **own the table, write the Compact, and decide who gets to stand behind the Barrier Fields.**

Tone

- **Cynical survival politics:** Every faction has a humane reason to lie.
- **Corporate black-box dread:** Kairos was never just an ancient archive. It is a sealed corporate sync weapon record, trained on people and buried under discovery language.
- **Territory as argument:** Barrier Fields, formally Claim Barriers, convert land into leverage. A path is never only blocked; it is owned.
- **Companion stakes without base permadeath:** Base attacks injure companions and pause production. They do not kill the base-22. Expedition Echo rescue can fail permanently.
- **Hope with teeth:** The Broker ending is not soft peace. It is a written settlement with enforcement, witnesses, and enemies.

Kairos Corporate Black-Box Truth

Kairos presents itself as a damaged archive because that story kept prior crews calm. Its true function is a **corporate black-box sync weapon archive**: a sealed memory lattice recording field tests, command overrides, companion synchronization failures, and black-budget leverage protocols.

Repairing Kairos requires restoring its shell, recovering **6 Memory Cores**, and earning enough trust that it stops treating the player as another operator. Each core is both a hardware repair and a political

escalation.

- Kairos, awakening:** "You are not operators. You are ammunition."
- Kairos, Core 3:** "Every faction says it wants order. Order is only violence with minutes."
- Kairos, Core 6:** "Expose me, arm me, or bind them all to paper strong enough to survive fire."

2. Shared Locks

Lock	V3 Fracture Compact Rule
Setting	Io, 2160
Economy	AC-only. Starter 5000 AC buys 1 starter Skilled Companion. No wallet, minting, marketplace, or third-party crypto loop
Roster	25 companions max: 22 base camp + 3 expedition trio
Kairos spine	Repair Kairos, recover 6 Memory Cores, earn trust, trigger Resonance Events
Biome order	B6 -> B1 -> B2 -> B3 -> B5 -> B4 -> B7
Side content	40 side quests, heavily NPC/board/faction driven
Puzzle content	40 puzzles, mixed purpose typed
Factions	5 base factions + 2 external factions
Territory	Barrier Fields are Claim Barriers, tied to faction reputation boards and control flags
Echo fail	Failed Echo rescue is permanent
Base harm	Base companions can be injured, never killed, by storms/building damage/raids
Storm production	Sulfur storms pause queues and push companions to Command Center rooms
Underground	S1-S5 strata support instanced depth pressure and blacksite content

3. Biome And Ecology Map

Status tags in this package follow the disk-truth split:

- **[SHIPPED]** Runtime exists on disk and can be treated as implemented.
- **[PARTIAL]** Runtime or content exists but is incomplete, prototype, or not final.
- **[PLANNED]** Design exists; implementation is future work.

Surface Biomes

Order	Biome	Status	Narrative Use	Ecology / Threat Hooks
1	B6 — Basalt Highlands	[PLANNED] biome content	Opening hub, first Claim Barriers, first fracture politics	Tube Jackals, Cliff Tube Lace Shelf, Cave Scout Moth, Ridge Tremor Beetle, Survey Beacon Drone, Comms Relay Walker
2	B1 — Sulfur Plains	[PARTIAL] biome content; Sulfur Hound [SHIPPED]	First core contest, storm claim economy, Scrim/Cordons rivalry	Sulfur Hound [SHIPPED], Cinder Skitter, Brimstone Fan, Haze Spore Shelf, Graveyard Scrapper Drone
3	B2 — Geyser Fields	[PLANNED] biome content	Lease fraud, seized corporate rig, vent tariff disputes	Vent Crab Worker, Vent Crab Queen, Plume Moth, Geyser Strider, Rusted Survey Drone, Vent Capper Bot
4	B3 — Ash Flats & Ridges	[PLANNED] biome content	Signal monopoly, board politics, Claim Barrier cascade	Dust Spout Cluster, Basalt Jackal, Ash Stalker, Ash Glass Wasp, Salvage Excavator Android, Claim Jumper
5	B5 — Polar Radiation Flats	[PLANNED] biome content	Smuggler routes, illegal core caches, rad permits	Void Kelp, Magnet Wurm, Rift Stalker, Cold Spire Hound, Smuggler Remnant Android, Mag-Clamp Drone
6	B4 — Lava Calderas	[PLANNED] biome content	Contract death site, heat permit gate, summit courier trial	Caldera Mantis, Heat Eel, Magma Skitter, Caldera Heat Kite, Eruption Sentry Bot
7	B7 — Precursor Ruin Belt	[PLANNED] biome content	Compact Vault, final Memory Core, ending arbitration	Vault Stalker, Silence Moth, Still Hunter Trace, Resonance Skimmer, Rust Garden, Corrupted Patrol Android

Underground Strata

Stratum	Name	Status	Political / Story Role	Ecology / Threat Hooks
S1	Upper Lava Tubes	[PLANNED]	First refuge offsets, smuggler crawlspaces, Scrim dead drops	Tube Lace, Tube Jackal, Cinder Tunnel Skitter, Rust Garden
S2	Mid Galleries	[PLANNED]	Symbiosis evidence, Lace Clinic trauma chain, blacksite approaches	Glass Kelp, Rift Skimmer, Glass Hive Swarmer, Brood Tunnel Warden, Symbiosis Subject
S3	Deep Volatile Basins	[PLANNED]	Brine claim disputes, dead-drop pools, evidence under waterline	Brine Fan, Basin Mantis, Brine Hound, Lamprey Spire Colony, Brood Mother Chamber
S4	Geothermal Roots	[PLANNED]	Heat-routing trials, Caldera contract proof, high-risk weapons cache	Silicate Mirror Bloom, Heat Eel, Magma Phase Crawler, Tremor Larva
S5	Resonance Vaults	[PLANNED]	Kairos black-box vault, final Compact evidence, ending locks	Echo Lichen, Aether Seep Petal, Vault Stalker, Echo Symbiont Swarm, Corrupted Patrol Android

Life Sheet Coverage

The ecology visual source is the Life Sheet set:

Sheet	Coverage	Package Use
LifeSheet_B1_B2_Sulfur_Geyser.png / RT_LifeSheet_B1_B2_Sulfur_Geyser.png	B1 + B2 organisms	Sulfur Hound, Vent Crabs, Plume Moths, Geyser Pods

Sheet	Coverage	Package Use
LifeSheet_B3_B4_Ash_Caldera.png / RT_LifeSheet_B3_B4_Ash_Caldera.png	B3 + B4 organisms	Dust Spouts, Basalt Jackals, Caldera Mantis, Heat Eel
LifeSheet_B5_B6_Polar_Highlands.png / RT_LifeSheet_B5_B6_Polar_Highlands.png	B5 + B6 organisms	Void Kelp, Magnet Wyrms, Tube Jackals, Cave Scout Moths
LifeSheet_B7_Ruins_Global.png / RT_LifeSheet_B7_Ruins_Global.png	B7 + global organisms	Vault Stalker, Silence Moth, Still Hunter, Void Stitcher, Rust Garden
LifeSheet_Underground_S1_S2.png / RT_LifeSheet_Underground_S1_S2.png	S1-S2	Tube Lace, Glass Kelp, Brood Warden
LifeSheet_Underground_S3_S4_S5.png / RT_LifeSheet_Underground_S3_S4_S5.png	S3-S5	Basin Mantis, Heat Eel, Echo Lichen
LifeSheet_Threats_Androids_Humanoids.png / RT_LifeSheet_Threats_Androids_Humanoids.png	Androids + humanoids	Corporate Security Remnants, smugglers, Corrupted Patrol Androids
LifeSheet_Threats_Machines_Flyers.png / RT_LifeSheet_Threats_Machines_Flyers.png	Machines + flyers	Scrap Mites, Turret Crawlers, Ash Glass Wasps, Ion Glass Bats

4. Systems Inventory

System	Status	V3 Fracture Compact Use
Aether Credits economy	[SHIPPED]	AC-only rewards, faction bribes, tariffs, permits, summit guarantees
Building Control Panels	[SHIPPED]	Per-building control, companion assignment, production/craft queues, political board terminals
Echo chronicle / EchoGenerator	[SHIPPED]	Trust beats, permanent fail consequence, companion political testimony
Exposure / oxygen / pressure	[SHIPPED]	B5 rad permits, B4 heat gates, B1 storm claims, underground pressure choices
Sulfur Hound B1	[SHIPPED]	Early ecology proof and B1 faction board hunt / route content
World Engine spine	[SHIPPED]	Reputation boards, GameState/WorldState snapshots, Directors driving claim shifts and Resonance Events
Combat	[SHIPPED]	Companion trio encounters, android clears, faction defense, sync weapon consequences
Weather	[PARTIAL]	Storm Claim Windows, sulfur storm queue pauses, ash gale puzzle embeds, ion lightning hazard politics
Quest framework	[PARTIAL]	Mainline triggers, side boards, faction reputation tasks, Compact Summit state flags
Hovercraft / vehicle gating	[PARTIAL]	Later biome access and external faction convoys, not main fantasy driver
Kairos / Memory Cores	[PLANNED]	Mainline repair spine, trust ladder, endings
Full Io biomes	[PLANNED]	B1-B7 surface campaign and ecology content
Underground	[PLANNED]	S1-S5 blacksites, dead drops, resonance vaults

System	Status	V3 Fracture Compact Use
Communications	[PLANNED]	Faction radio traffic, board postings, Compact Summit calls
Building modules	[PLANNED]	Claim Barrier generator, relay mesh, geothermal stabilizer, defense modules, mining/logistics hooks

Political Hooks Into Shipped/Planned Systems

- **Reputation boards:** BCP-accessible or in-world boards publish faction contracts, votes, bounties, and claim disputes.
- **Claim Barriers:** Barrier Fields are faction-owned gates with keys, hacks, bribes, storm windows, and reputation overrides.
- **World Engine:** Directors can shift claim ownership after storms, companion injuries, faction votes, or Resonance Events.
- **AC economy:** Every political favor has an AC price, but not every AC payment buys trust.

5. AC Tier Curve And Reward Rules

AC Tier Curve

Tier	Campaign Range	Typical Reward	Use Cases
T1	Early B6/B1	150-450 AC	Starter board jobs, minor puzzles, first salvage disputes
T2	B2/B3	500-950 AC	Mid-side quests, faction permits, weapon module rewards
T3	B5/B4	1100-2200 AC	Dangerous side chains, elite ecology contracts, blacksite evidence
T4	B7 / endgame	2500-5200 AC	Summit work, final vault puzzles, faction capstones, ending commitments

Application Rules

- **Mainline:** Uses milestone payouts sparingly. Mainline rewards primarily unlock systems, cores, modules, weapons, and access.
- **Side quests:** Scale from T1 to T4 by faction arc and biome. Most side quests pay AC plus gear or reputation.
- **Puzzles:** Purpose determines payout. Access Gate puzzles often pay low AC but unlock progress. Loot/Cache/Weapon and Optional Mastery puzzles can pay higher AC and named modules.
- **Faction contracts:** AC can be matched by gear, permits, board rank, or named weapon modules.

Named Weapon And Module Families

Family	Examples	Reward Channels
Claim weapons	Claim Rifle, Fracture Pike, Barrier Spike	Cordons side quests, Claim Barrier puzzles
Archive tools	Archive Lens, Redact Torch, Directive Coil	Archive sides, blacksite puzzles, Expose path

Family	Examples	Reward Channels
Scrim gear	Scrim Cutters, Mag-Claw, Fence Stamp	Scrim board, salvage puzzles, cache rewards
Lace tools	Lace Collar, Soft Injector, Ethics Band	Lace Clinic, Echo stabilization, anti-weaponize path
Bureau tools	Vote Slate, Tariff Tag, Bureau Pack	Manifest Bureau, broker puzzles, summit path
Helix weapons	Compliance Carbine, Seizure Drone, Black Directive Chip	Helix contracts, corporate seals, Weaponize path
Seam gear	Seam Cloak, Mute Boots, Seal Picks	Seam Compact, smuggler seals, stealth puzzles
Aether modules	Sync Capacitor, Resonance Baffle, Core-Sniffer Array	Mainline cores, B7 vaults, mastery puzzles

6. Mainline Progress-Triggered Arc

Mainline uses **progress triggers, not quest givers**. NPCs, faction votes, and Compact summits live primarily in side/faction content. The mainline is location, repair, core, building, and Resonance triggered.

Mainline Table

ID	Mainline Beat	Trigger	Biome / Site	Core / Repair	AC / Gear Reward	Est.	Status
ML-01	Compact Zero	First B6 base camp boot + starter companion purchase	B6 Command Center	Kairos shell ping	5000 AC starter spend; Pioneer Sidearm	2.0h	[PLANNED] narrative
ML-02	Black-Box Shell	Scan buried black-box casing under basalt ash	B6 annex	Kairos shell found	300 AC; Archive Lens Mk I	2.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-03	Redacted Auth Spindle	Enter first Claim Barrier annex	B6 Claim Annex	Repair part 1	Barrier Spike Module	2.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-04	Sync Capacitor Bank	Survive first B1 sulfur storm window at isotope camp	B1 Sulfur Plains	Repair part 2	450 AC; Storm Filter Module	2.5h	[PARTIAL] ecology hook via Sulfur Hound
ML-05	Black Directive Coupler	Breach B2 seized rig inner lock	B2 Geyser Fields	Repair part 3	Directive Coil , unlock Kairos wake	2.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-06	Kairos Wake	Install all 3 repair parts in BCP-linked archive cradle	Base Camp	Trust Angry	Sync Capacitor Mk I	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-07	Core 1: Corporate Directive	Recover storm-buried sync record after hound route / drone fight	B1	Memory Core 1	650 AC; Fracture Pike	3.0h	[PLANNED]

ID	Mainline Beat	Trigger	Biome / Site	Core / Repair	AC / Gear Reward	Est.	Status
ML-08	Resonance 1: Reboot Ledger	Attach Core 1; Synergy Overcharge hits trio	Base / B1	Trust Wary	Lace Stabilizer Module	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-09	Core 2: Lease Seismic	Decode falsified vent lease after timed geyser vault	B2	Memory Core 2	900 AC; Geothermal Stabilizer	3.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-10	Resonance 2: Paper Claims	Install Geothermal Stabilizer through BCP	Base building	Building module unlock	Vent Seal Kit	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-11	Core 3: Signal Monopoly	Break B3 beacon tariff sequence	B3 Ash Flats & Ridges	Memory Core 3	1200 AC; Relay Breaker SMG	3.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-12	Resonance 3: Private Channel	Signal blackout opens private Kairos trust scene	Base / B3 relay	Trust Advisor	Scout Relay Mesh	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-13	Core 4: Smuggler Mirror	Recover illegal core from B5 polar cache	B5 Polar Radiation Flats	Memory Core 4	1700 AC; Seam Cloak Module	3.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-14	Resonance 4: Illegal Truth	Attach Core 4; rad inversion reveals hidden routes	B5 / Base	Rad Suit Mk II	Core-Sniffer Array	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-15	Core 5: Caldera Contract	Find failed sync weapon death site under heat lock	B4 Lava Calderas	Memory Core 5	2100 AC; Compliance Carbine or Redact Torch Mk II	3.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-16	Resonance 5: The Contract Killed Them	Building injury spike; BCP emergency response	Base / B4	Trust Friend	Resonance Baffle	1.5h	[PLANNED]
ML-17	Core 6: Compact Vault	Open B7 lock triad with repaired Kairos	B7 Precursor Ruin Belt	Memory Core 6	3000 AC; Aether Lattice Key	4.0h	[PLANNED]
ML-18	Final Choice: Expose / Weaponize / Broker	Install Core 6 and select terminal doctrine	B7 / Base	Ending triad	Ending-specific weapon/module; 5200 AC reserve grant	3.0h	[PLANNED]

Mainline subtotal: 41 hours.

Six Cores

Core	Name	Biome	Black-Box Truth	Resonance Event	Unlock	Political Meaning
C1	Corporate Directive	B1	Sync weapon tests were run on personnel	Synergy Overcharge: trio buff then Reboot incident	Probe Uplink Tower	Helix can be proven culpable
C2	Lease Seismic	B2	Vent leases were falsified to own future infrastructure	Stability Bubble over one faction HQ	Geothermal Stabilizer	Land claims are manufactured
C3	Signal Monopoly	B3	Beacons were tariff gates, not rescue tools	12-minute Comms Blackout	Scout Relay Mesh	Whoever owns signal owns the vote

Core	Name	Biome	Black-Box Truth	Resonance Event	Unlock	Political Meaning
C4	Smuggler Mirror	B5	Illegal cores moved through "rescue" channels	Cold Lens rad inversion	Rad Suit Mk II	Seam routes are criminal and necessary
C5	Caldera Contract	B4	Caldera crew died in a contracted sync weapon trial	Magma Mirror + base injury spike	Heat Lock Override	Corporate paper killed the expedition
C6	Compact Vault	B7	Kairos can expose, arm, or bind all parties	Resonance Supercell Lite	Vault doctrine terminal	The player writes Io's settlement

Trust Dialogue Ladder

Trust Stage	Trigger	Kairos Voice
Angry	Wake after repair parts	"Your factions are children with knives. Your corporations are adults with invoices."
Wary	Core 1	"Power recorded. Who did you sell it to first?"
Adversarial Advisor	Core 2	"Barrier Field on Ridge Seven is not natural. It is a claim with better lighting."
Cynical Partner	Core 3	"You call it a board vote because auction sounds ugly."
Quiet Confessor	Core 4	"The smugglers broke law. The law broke first."
Friend	Core 5	"Do not confuse peace with silence. The contract was silent too."
Final Witness	Core 6	"Expose, weaponize, or broker. Choose the lie you can enforce."

Endings

Ending	Choice	Outcome	Reward
Expose	Broadcast the Directive Archive evidence and burn Helix leverage	Helix collapses locally; camp is free but economically fragile	Redact Torch Prime , Archive reputation cap, public proof codex
Weaponize	Keep the sync lattice and turn Kairos into controlled deterrence	Military order, stronger defense, major trust loss with Lace/Archive	Aether Lattice Rifle , Seizure Drone upgrade, high Claim Barrier control
Broker	Bind seven factions into the Fracture Compact	Durable but tense peace; no faction fully wins	Compact Seal Module , Vote Slate Prime, balanced board access

7. Side Quests — 40

Side quests are NPC, board, and faction heavy. This is where the political fantasy lives: council votes, favors, public contracts, bribes, faction disputes, and local grudges.

ID	Title	Faction / Source	Biome	Type	Objective	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
SQ-01	First Blood Compact	Fracture Cordons board	B6	Arbitration	Break up a salvage fight and decide who pays injury costs	T1 250 AC	Fracture Plate Liner	1.2h

ID	Title	Faction / Source	Biome	Type	Objective	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
SQ-02	Spike The Field	Cordons marshal	B3	Territory	Place a temporary Claim Spike on a contested ash route	T1 350 AC	Barrier Spike	1.3h
SQ-03	Storm Claim	Cordons board	B1	Holdout	Hold a sulfur-storm claim without killing rival workers	T2 600 AC	Claim Rifle	1.4h
SQ-04	Silent Wire	Cordons scout	B3	Stealth / Combat	Clear an android relay without tripping public alarm	T2 700 AC	Mute Sling Module	1.3h
SQ-05	Barrier Brief	Cordons analyst	B3	Recon	Map 3 Claim Barriers and identify owner keys	T2 650 AC	Claim Barrier matrix update	1.1h
SQ-06	Cordon Legend	Cordons captain	B4	Escort	Protect a summit courier through heat and Caldera Mantis territory	T3 1700 AC	Fracture Pike Mk II	1.8h
SQ-07	Redact Primer	Directive Archive board	B1	Evidence	Collect Directive scraps from a failed isotope camp	T1 300 AC	Archive Lens	1.1h
SQ-08	Fake Lease	Archive whistleblower	B2	Investigation	Prove a Helix seismic lease contradicts vent data	T2 750 AC	Redact Torch	1.3h
SQ-09	Polar Whistle	Archive board	B5	Evidence	Choose whether smuggler records or Helix logs go public first	T3 1400 AC	Sample Case Mk II	1.5h
SQ-10	Publish Fork	Archive council	B6	Political Choice	Leak early for chaos or hold proof for summit leverage	T2 900 AC	Archive reputation fork	1.0h
SQ-11	Shelf Frequency	Archive specialist	B7	Puzzle / Lore	Tune Resonance Echo Shelves to decode Directive backups	T4 2600 AC	Directive Coil	1.4h
SQ-12	Archive Finale	Archive board	B7	Evidence Capstone	Recover a secondary black-box shard	T4 3200 AC	Redact Torch Prime	1.5h
SQ-13	Contested Haul	Scrim Compact board	B1	Salvage	Beat Cordons to a storm-exposed wreck without losing the crew	T1 400 AC	Scrim Cutters	1.2h
SQ-14	Mag Debt	Scrim foreman	B2	Salvage	Retrieve a Mag-Claw from a Helix-sealed vent pit	T2 700 AC	Mag-Claw	1.2h
SQ-15	Fence Night	Scrim broker	B3	Stealth / Trade	Move a fence stamp through a Claim Barrier checkpoint	T2 850 AC	Fence Stamp	1.1h
SQ-16	Crust Drop	Scrim board	S1-S3	Depth Push	Recover a dead drop hidden under unsafe crust	T3 1500 AC	Crust Anchor Module	1.5h

ID	Title	Faction / Source	Biome	Type	Objective	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
SQ-17	Price War	Scrim / Bureau dispute	B6	Debate	Break or endorse Bureau tariffs on contested salvage	T2 800 AC	Vendor fee modifier	0.9h
SQ-18	Scrim Legend	Scrim syndics	B4	Salvage Capstone	Loot a contract wreck during a heat lull	T3 1900 AC	Scrim Cutter Mk II	1.7h
SQ-19	After Reboot	Lace Clinic board	B6	Medical / Echo	Treat a Rebooted trio member and investigate sync harm	T1 450 AC	Lace Collar	1.2h
SQ-20	Voss Wire	Lace Clinic / Voss Nyx	B3	Companion	Resolve ghost relay politics without selling Voss out	T2 850 AC	Voss bond perk	1.3h
SQ-21	Draven Stabilized	Lace Clinic / Draven-4	B1	Companion	Stabilize a hostile imprint after a weaponized Echo scare	T2 900 AC	Soft Injector	1.4h
SQ-22	Solara Heat	Lace Clinic / Solara	B4	Companion	Keep a thermal lab survivor off Helix custody lists	T3 1650 AC	Solara bond perk	1.3h
SQ-23	Quill Fault	Lace Clinic / Quill	B2	Companion / Evidence	Use seismic claim evidence to clear Quill's name	T2 950 AC	Ethics Band	1.3h
SQ-24	Lace Soften	Lace Clinic board	B6	Stabilization	Cleanse weaponize Saturation from one building loop	T3 1300 AC	Lace Soften Module	1.2h
SQ-25	Bureau Open	Manifest Bureau board	B6	Founding	Stand up the neutral broker desk	T1 200 AC	Bureau Pack	0.8h
SQ-26	Tariff Storm	Bureau dispatcher	B1	Escort	Deliver votes through shifting storm claims	T2 650 AC	Vote Slate	1.3h
SQ-27	Vent Broker	Bureau board	B2	Escort / Trade	Run a neutral convoy past vent lease checkpoints	T2 750 AC	Tariff Tag	1.2h
SQ-28	Signal Fee	Bureau adjudicator	B3	Political Choice	Pay, break, or redirect the signal monopoly	T2 950 AC	Tariff Cut Module	1.3h
SQ-29	Polar Broker	Bureau board	B5	Delivery	Maintain cold-chain custody of evidence	T3 1550 AC	Bureau vendor discount	1.2h
SQ-30	Bureau Legend	Bureau summit clerk	B7	Escort Capstone	Carry final Compact logistics through silent corridors	T4 2800 AC	Vote Slate Prime	1.6h
SQ-31	Lease Drop	Helix Compact Envoys	B2	Political Entry	Accept visitor status without ceding base sovereignty	T1 350 AC	Black Directive Chip	0.8h
SQ-32	Seizure	Helix contract board	B1	Combat / Seizure	Seize a Scrim crate under corporate paperwork	T2 800 AC	Seizure Drone	1.2h

ID	Title	Faction / Source	Biome	Type	Objective	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
SQ-33	Compliance	Helix auditor	B5	Recon	Audit Seam routes without tipping Cordons	T3 1600 AC	Compliance Armor	1.4h
SQ-34	Override Trial	Helix envoy	B7	Puzzle / Access	Open a corporate vault seal with a Directive override	T4 3000 AC	Directive Override Module	1.5h
SQ-35	Helix Ultimatum	Helix Compact Envoys	B6	Choice Capstone	Ally, expose, or weaponize with Helix at the table	T4 4200 AC	Compliance Carbine	1.1h
SQ-36	Seal Meet	Seam Compact contact	B5	Political Entry	Buy the first Seal Pick and learn the smuggler map	T1 300 AC	Mute Boots	0.8h
SQ-37	Sleeve Run	Seam board	B5	Stealth	Move a false core past Cordons scanners	T3 1450 AC	Seam Cloak	1.4h
SQ-38	Stitcher Tip	Seam survivor	B3	Encounter / Lore	Verify the warning: "Do not trust the seams."	T3 1300 AC	Seam Needle Armor Mod	1.3h
SQ-39	Barrier Market	Seam board	B3	Puzzle / Trade	Buy, sell, or burn a Claim Barrier bypass market	T3 1750 AC	Seal Pick Skill	1.5h
SQ-40	Seam Legend	Seam Compact	B7	Silent Escort	Move a protected asset past Still Hunter pressure to the summit	T4 3500 AC	Seal Picks Prime	1.8h

Side quest subtotal: 51 hours.

8. Puzzles — 40 Purpose-Typed

Purpose distribution:

- **Access Gate:** 8
- **Loot / Cache / Weapon:** 8
- **Environmental Survival:** 7
- **Combat / Encounter:** 6
- **Story / Reveal:** 6
- **Optional Mastery:** 5

ID	Title	Purpose	Biome / Site	Solve Grammar	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
PQ-01	Annex Claim Field	Access Gate	B6 annex	Hack, Cordon key, or Seam pick	T1 150 AC	Opens Redacted Auth Spindle route	1.0h

ID	Title	Purpose	Biome / Site	Solve Grammar	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
PQ-02	Capacitor Storm Lock	Access Gate	B1 isotope camp	Open during sulfur storm lull	T1 250 AC	Storm Filter Module	1.1h
PQ-03	Coupler Choice Gate	Access Gate	B2 seized rig	Helix chip or Seam pick	T2 500 AC	Black Directive Coupler	1.2h
PQ-04	Smuggler Seal A	Access Gate	B5 polar route	Seal Pick timing	T2 650 AC	Opens Seam route	1.0h
PQ-05	Contract Heat Lock	Access Gate	B4 death site	Heat Override and cooled crust path	T3 1200 AC	Heat Lock Override	1.3h
PQ-06	Compact Locks A	Access Gate	B7 outer vault	Three surface locks	T4 2500 AC	Vault access flag	1.5h
PQ-07	Triple Key Barrier	Access Gate	Act III shared route	Cordons + Archive + Seam tools	T3 1800 AC	Compact Key Fragment	1.5h
PQ-08	Broker Seal	Access Gate	Final terminal	Seven-faction seal alignment	T4 3200 AC	Broker ending route	1.5h
PQ-09	Cordons Armory	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B6 HQ	Trusted board rank + safe combination	T1 300 AC	Claim Rifle	0.8h
PQ-10	Scrim Mag-Lock	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B1 yard	Mag-Claw lift and fence code	T1 350 AC	Scrim Cutters	0.9h
PQ-11	Archive Cleanroom	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B5 lab	Contamination route puzzle	T2 800 AC	Redact Torch Mk II	1.0h
PQ-12	Helix Black Seal	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B2 lander	Directive chip sequence	T2 950 AC	Compliance Carbine Mod	1.1h
PQ-13	Seam False Wall	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B5 smuggler cut	Mute Boots + Seal Pick	T2 900 AC	Seam Cloak Liner	1.0h
PQ-14	Crust Lottery Drop	Loot/Cache/Weapon	S3 volatile basin	Lattice path memorization	T3 1500 AC	Crust Anchor Module	1.2h
PQ-15	Android Dig Lease	Loot/Cache/Weapon	B7 dig	Cipher proves lease fraud, then unlocks frame	T4 2800 AC	Seizure Drone Upgrade	1.3h
PQ-16	Weaponize Cage	Loot/Cache/Weapon	Final weapon vault	Arm or disarm lattice safely	T4 3600 AC	Aether Lattice Rifle	1.4h
PQ-17	Void Kelp Wire	Environmental Survival	B5 kelp grove	Scan quietly through rad pulse	T2 750 AC	Rad-shield gel recipe	1.1h
PQ-18	Flooded Tube Brief	Environmental Survival	S2 flooded junction	Wade route and O2 timing	T2 600 AC	O2 Valve Module	1.0h
PQ-19	Cover Relay Bribe	Environmental Survival	B5/B4 relay	Cross pulse/heat cover lanes; bribe optional	T3 1400 AC	Relay Baffle	1.2h
PQ-20	Spout Checkpoint	Environmental Survival	B3 ash route	Predict Dust Spout paths	T2 700 AC	Ash ceramic cache	1.0h
PQ-21	Pulse Toll	Environmental Survival	B2 geyser bridge	Pay tariff or master vent timing	T2 650 AC	Vent shortcut unlock	1.0h
PQ-22	Gas Dome Blacksite	Environmental Survival	S4/S5 blacksite	Vent pressure and Redact Read	T3 1700 AC	Gas Dome Filter	1.3h

ID	Title	Purpose	Biome / Site	Solve Grammar	AC Tier / Reward	Gear / Module	Est.
PQ-23	Silent Summit Path	Environmental Survival	B7 silent zone	Avoid Silence Moths and Still Hunter trace	T4 2600 AC	Summit escort shortcut	1.1h
PQ-24	Directive Cage	Combat/Encounter	B1 Core 1 vault	Pattern solve while drones fire	T2 800 AC	Fracture Pike	1.2h
PQ-25	Reboot Chamber	Combat/Encounter	Base emergency room	Stabilize lace puzzle under sync aftershock	T2 700 AC	Soft Injector Module	1.1h
PQ-26	Rockfall Ambush	Combat/Encounter	S1/S2 tunnel	Drop rocks on pursuers or block escape	T2 850 AC	Tunnel route unlock	1.1h
PQ-27	Multi-Breach Claim	Combat/Encounter	B3 ridge maze	Blast, quiet route, or bribe under ambush	T3 1300 AC	Barrier Spike Mk II	1.2h
PQ-28	Petal Blackmail	Combat/Encounter	B7 vault	Align petal under Hunter pressure	T4 3000 AC	Vault Glass Mod	1.5h
PQ-29	Void Stitcher Proof	Combat/Encounter	Global seam POI	Survive reveal, force retreat, collect seam needle	T3 1800 AC	Seam Needle Armor Mod	1.3h
PQ-30	Lease Seismic Vault	Story/Reveal	B2 vent vault	Compare scanner truth to false papers	T2 900 AC	Core 2 evidence	1.2h
PQ-31	Signal Tariff Gate	Story/Reveal	B3 beacons	Break monopoly sequence	T2 950 AC	Core 3 evidence	1.2h
PQ-32	Frequency Blackmail	Story/Reveal	B7 Echo Shelf	Wrong pitch raises Saturation threat	T3 1500 AC	Helix blackmail file	1.2h
PQ-33	Dual Blacksite	Story/Reveal	S5 vault approach	Two-dome synchronization	T3 1700 AC	Rare proof cache	1.2h
PQ-34	Compact Locks B	Story/Reveal	B7 inner vault	Petals + faction keys reveal Kairos truth	T4 3000 AC	Core 6 route	1.5h
PQ-35	Summit Seal	Story/Reveal	Final chamber	Expose, Weaponize, or Broker doctrine lock	T4 4200 AC	Ending doctrine	1.6h
PQ-36	Barrier Cascade	Optional Mastery	B3 contested field	Link 3 Claim Barriers to reroute ownership	T3 1900 AC	Claim map overlay	1.4h
PQ-37	Barrier Auction	Optional Mastery	B6 generator	Bid AC, siphon Strain, or steal key	T3 2200 AC	Master Barrier Key	1.4h
PQ-38	Bureau Vault	Optional Mastery	B6 market	Vote Slate timing across factions	T2 1000 AC	Bureau vendor upgrade	1.0h
PQ-39	Smuggler Seal B	Optional Mastery	B5 Core 4 vault	Dual Seal + Archive Lens	T3 2100 AC	Seal Picks Prime Part	1.3h
PQ-40	Caldera Mantis Trophy Lock	Optional Mastery	B4 rim cache	Lure mantis into heat shadow pressure trap	T4 3100 AC	Mantis Shell Armor Module	1.5h

Puzzle subtotal: 48 hours.

9. Factions V3

FB1 — Fracture Cordons

Role: Security faction, claim enforcers, "order before consent."

Formation trigger: First public injury during a contested B6 salvage fight.

Board fantasy: Patrol contracts, defense votes, route claims, escort work.

Signature gear: Fracture Plate, Claim Rifle, Barrier Spike, Fracture Pike.

Conflict lines: Hates Seam bypasses, distrusts Scrim theft, resents Helix privatization.

FB2 — Directive Archive

Role: Science / records faction split between whistleblowers and careerists.

Formation trigger: Core 1 proves sync testing language was buried.

Board fantasy: Evidence recovery, public proof, black-box decoding.

Signature gear: Archive Lens, Redact Torch, Directive Coil, Sample Case.

Conflict lines: Expose path ally; Weaponize path opponent unless careerists win.

FB3 — Scrim Compact

Role: Salvage syndics, rough labor politics, practical thieves.

Formation trigger: First contested haul after B1 storm salvage opens.

Board fantasy: Hauls, fences, dead drops, route work, claim subversion.

Signature gear: Scrim Cutters, Mag-Claw, Fence Stamp, Crust Anchor.

Conflict lines: Says Cordons protect ownership, not people.

FB4 — Lace Clinic

Role: Medical, Echo ethics, anti-weaponize conscience.

Formation trigger: First Synergy Overcharge / Reboot incident.

Board fantasy: Stabilization, rescue, anti-Saturation work, companion trauma.

Signature gear: Lace Collar, Soft Injector, Ethics Band, Lace Soften Module.

Conflict lines: Opposes Helix and the Weaponize ending.

FB5 — Manifest Bureau

Role: Logistics brokers, tariff clerks, vote counters, neutral only on paper.

Formation trigger: AC market surplus and disputed board payment after B2/B3.

Board fantasy: Convoys, price disputes, summit paperwork, settlement enforcement.

Signature gear: Bureau Pack, Vote Slate, Tariff Tag, Compact Seal Module.

Conflict lines: Broker ending backbone; accused of selling peace by the kilogram.

FX1 — Helix Compact Envoys

Role: External corporate faction, antagonist or temporary ally.

Arrival trigger: Kairos repair wake plus B2 lease evidence.

Board fantasy: Compliance contracts, seizures, audits, corporate seals.
Signature gear: Compliance Armor, Compliance Carbine, Seizure Drone, Black Directive Chip.
Conflict lines: Wants Kairos contained, purchased, or turned back into doctrine.

FX2 — Seam Compact

Role: External smugglers, route sellers, illegal but often correct.
Arrival trigger: Core 4 smuggling thread and polar route rumors.
Board fantasy: Seal picks, false walls, dead drops, silent escorts.
Signature gear: Seam Cloak, Mute Boots, Seal Picks, Seam Needle Armor Mod.
Conflict lines: Treats every law as a receipt for previous theft.

10. Friction And Claim Barrier Matrix

Friction Set

ID	Friction	Effect	Primary Counterplay
F1	Claim Barrier Field	Blocks routes, caches, HQ wings, and votes until ownership is addressed	Faction key, hack, bribe, storm window, Seam pick
F2	Smuggler Seal	Hides contraband paths and false walls	Seal Pick, Mute Boots, Archive Lens
F3	Vault Lock Triad	Requires surface locks plus B7 petal alignment	Core progress, faction keys, Kairos trust
F4	Storm Claim Window	Ownership and harvest rights shift during weather peaks	Timed travel, board contract, Cordons or Scrim rep
F5	Echo Sync Gamble	Echo rescue can fail permanently; weaponize route increases risk	Lace Clinic tools, lower Saturation, careful trio choices
F6	Rad / Heat Permit Gate	B5/B4 pressure zones require kit, permit, or route mastery	Rad Suit Mk II, Heat Lock Override, Bureau permits
F7	Gas Dome Blacksite	Underground corporate labs require pressure routing	Gas Dome Filter, Redact Read, vent timing
F8	Floor Crust Dead Drop	Unsafe crust hides smuggler caches	Crust Anchor, Scout reads, Scrim tools
F9	Saturation Leverage	High Saturation lets Helix or Lace pressure the player politically	Lace Soften, ethics choices, public proof
F10	Still Hunter / Void Stitcher Pressure	Apex pressure forces route, quiet, or retreat decisions	Scout warning, Tactician block, silence discipline

Claim Barrier Gate Matrix

Barrier Group	Location	Owner Bias	Blocks	Unlock Routes	Political Consequence
CB-01	B6 Annex Field	Cordons / Helix	Auth Spindle	Hack, Cordon rank, Helix chip, Seam pick	First lesson that access is ownership

Barrier Group	Location	Owner Bias	Blocks	Unlock Routes	Political Consequence
CB-02	B1 Storm Claim Ring	Cordons / Scrim	Isotope camp salvage	Storm timing, board contract, bribe	Decides who profits from early sulfur salvage
CB-03	B2 Lease Fence	Helix / Archive	Seized rig inner	Lease proof, Directive chip, vent timing	Opens public lease scandal
CB-04	B3 Signal Tariff Gate	Bureau / Helix	Relay mesh	Pay tariff, break signal, Archive proof	Sets signal monopoly reputation
CB-05	B3 Barrier Cascade	Cordons / Seam	Four contested POIs	Link fields, steal key, broker vote	Converts side territory into player leverage
CB-06	B5 Polar Seal Grid	Seam / Helix	Illegal core cache	Seal Pick, Compliance audit, rad permit	Determines Core 4 public story
CB-07	B4 Heat Permit Lock	Bureau / Cordons	Contract death site	Heat Override, escort writ, mastery route	Decides who testifies at summit
CB-08	B7 Compact Vault Field	All factions	Core 6 and endings	Three surface locks, petal alignment, faction keys	Final table ownership

Compact Summit

The Compact Summit is side/faction content that becomes visible around Core 6, not the mainline giver. The mainline triggers the vault and doctrine terminal. The summit decides which factions show up, what evidence enters the record, and whether the final choice has legitimacy.

Summit Lever	Source	Effect
Public proof	Directive Archive	Strengthens Expose
Enforcement pledge	Fracture Cordons	Strengthens Broker or Weaponize
Worker vote	Scrim Compact	Lowers AC tariffs if respected
Echo ethics charter	Lace Clinic	Weakens Weaponize, protects Echo rescue
Tariff schedule	Manifest Bureau	Makes Broker enforceable
Corporate indemnity	Helix Envoys	Makes Weaponize easier, Expose harder
Route immunity	Seam Compact	Opens Broker smuggler amnesty or blackmail

11. Hour Budget

Exploration/free roam is excluded from the designed total.

Bucket	Hours
Mainline progress-triggered arc	41
Side quests, 40 total	51
Puzzles, 40 total	48

Bucket	Hours
Faction reputation, boards, votes, Claim Barrier shifts	16
Systemic repeatables, weather claims, evidence runs, elite pressure	18
Designed total	174
Exploration / free roam bonus	Not counted

Repeatable Content Budget

Repeatable	Est.	Notes
Claim Barrier re-contests after sulfur storms / ash gales	5h	Territory shifts, board updates, AC bounties
Reputation board contracts	4h	Faction-specific repeatable variants
Weather claim windows	3h	B1/B3/B5 pressure gates
Evidence runs / blacksite reroutes	3h	Archive, Helix, Seam variants
Elite pressure events	3h	Void Stitcher, Still Hunter trace, Magnet Wyrms, Caldera Mantis

12. Sample Dialogue And Compact Vote Snippets

Kairos

"The first lie was archive. The second was safety. The third was that anyone here can afford honesty without a weapon."

"A Claim Barrier is not a wall. It is a sentence: this far, and no further, unless you accept the author."

"Do not ask whether Helix owns the crime. Ask who profits if the crime becomes infrastructure."

Fracture Cordons

"We do not hold the Barrier because we love fences. We hold it because the last open road came back with three suits cracked and a medic crying."

Directive Archive

"Publish now and Helix burns the paper trail. Hold until summit and people call us cowards. Science is easy. Timing is filth."

Scrim Compact

"The Cordons call it theft when we take from a crate. Helix calls it lease recovery when they take the moon."

Lace Clinic

"You can weaponize the Echoes. You can even win with them. Then you can explain to the survivors why their rescue sounded like a trigger pull."

Manifest Bureau

"A Compact without tariffs is poetry. Very inspiring. Very dead by winter."

Helix Compact Envoys

"Dark Matter did not discover Kairos. You opened a sealed liability. Our offer is not ownership. It is containment with benefits."

Seam Compact

"Law is a locked door with a guard who forgot who built the room. We remember the maintenance tunnels."

Compact Vote Snippets

Vote	Snippet	Mechanical Hook
Vote 1: Barrier Amnesty	"All unauthorized Barrier keys declared by sunrise are forgiven. Hidden keys become hostile acts."	Reveals or preserves Seam bypasses
Vote 2: Echo Ethics Charter	"No Echo is to be attached to a sync lattice without recorded consent or emergency witness."	Lowers Echo fail chance, weakens Weaponize
Vote 3: Tariff Ceiling	"No faction may price oxygen, heat, or storm shelter beyond emergency ceiling."	Reduces AC costs, angers Helix/Scrim profiteers
Vote 4: Directive Publication	"The black-box record enters public archive, redactions named and logged."	Opens Expose route legitimacy
Vote 5: Deterrence Custody	"Kairos remains armed under council seal and Kade's key."	Opens Weaponize legitimacy
Vote 6: Route Amnesty	"Smuggler medical and rescue routes are lawful if declared to the Bureau."	Opens Broker route with Seam support
Vote 7: Compact Ratification	"Io recognizes no owner without witness, service, and repair."	Broker ending lock

Ending Closing Lines

Expose:

Kairos: "The record is public. The weapon is no longer clean. That is not justice, but it is oxygen."

Weaponize:

| Kairos: "You made the table obey. Remember that obedience is not agreement."

Broker:

| Kairos: "Paper burns. So do people. Today you made the paper harder to burn first."

13. Package Summary

V3 Fracture Compact reframes Io as faction territory and Kairos as corporate sync weapon leverage. Mainline progression remains trigger-driven through repair parts, Memory Cores, building unlocks, Resonance Events, and final doctrine choice. Political texture lives in NPCs, boards, Claim Barriers, side quests, and Compact Summit votes.

Designed total: 174 hours, exploration excluded.

Core fantasy: Own the table. Write the Compact. Decide what Barrier Fields mean.